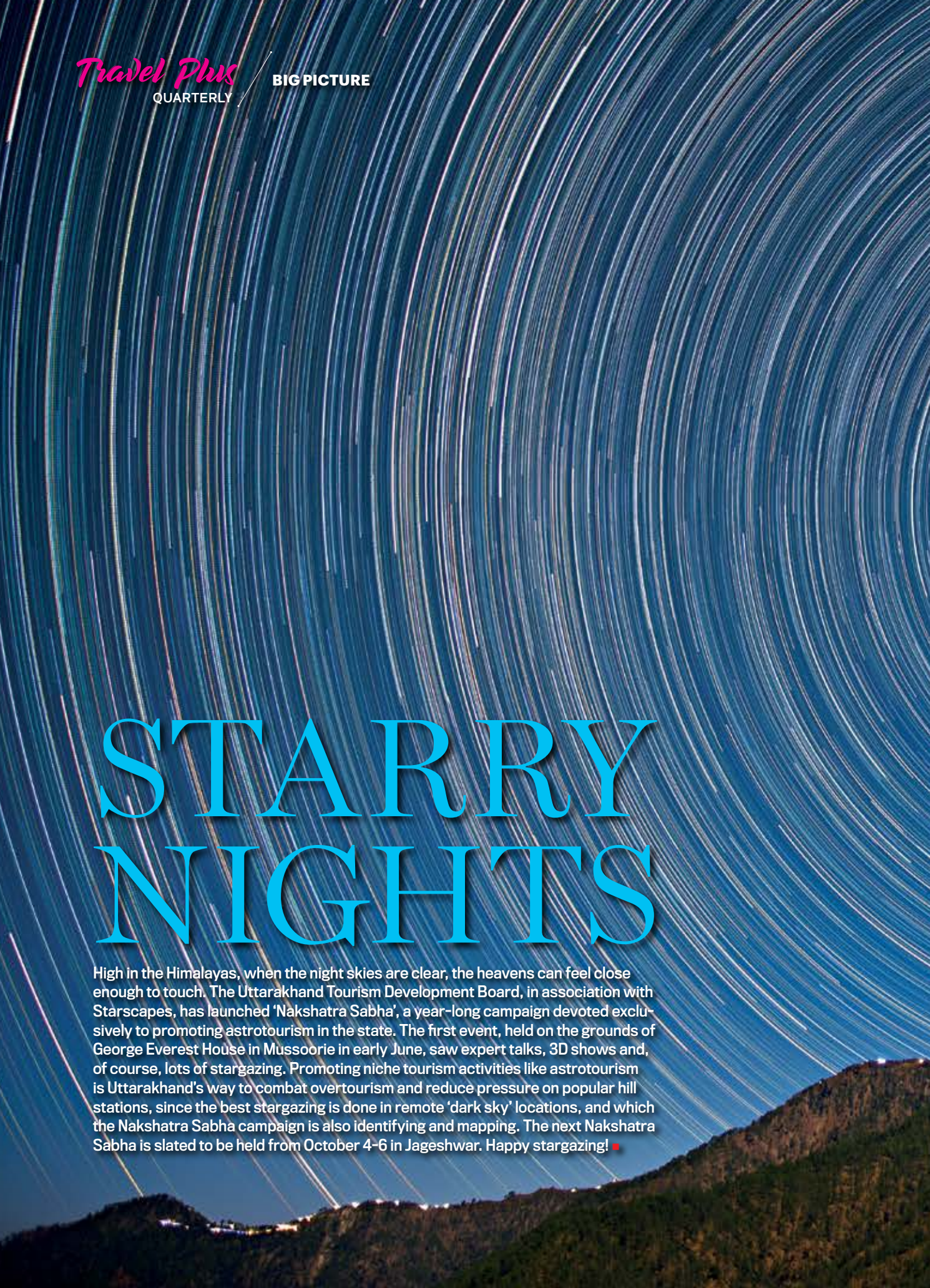


STARRY NIGHTS

High in the Himalayas, when the night skies are clear, the heavens can feel close enough to touch. The Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board, in association with Starscapes, has launched 'Nakshatra Sabha', a year-long campaign devoted exclusively to promoting astrotourism in the state. The first event, held on the grounds of George Everest House in Mussoorie in early June, saw expert talks, 3D shows and, of course, lots of stargazing. Promoting niche tourism activities like astrotourism is Uttarakhand's way to combat overtourism and reduce pressure on popular hill stations, since the best stargazing is done in remote 'dark sky' locations, and which the Nakshatra Sabha campaign is also identifying and mapping. The next Nakshatra Sabha is slated to be held from October 4-6 in Jageshwar. Happy stargazing!